INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

GUIDELINE FOR AVOIDING PLAGIARISM

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Misprints and errors are reserved.

YOUR FIRST WRITTEN ASSIGNMENT? HOW DO I START? WHERE DO I START?

Without the necessary support, it can turn into an enormous challenge and lead to students feeling completely overworked and stressed. An **academic paper depends on the correct citation method**. Before you start writing, it is therefore necessary to clarify the exact citation method. You can find all the important information about the **correct citation** here:
https://mycampus.iubh.de/pluginfile.php/370135/mod_resource/content/5/General%20Citation%20Guidelines.pdf?redirect=1

From time to time, students receive notification of plagiarism, which is not due to an attempt to deceive, but simply due to lack of knowledge. So how can I avoid plagiarism? In this guide you will find all the important information you need to avoid unnecessary mistakes.

1. WHAT IS PLAGIARISM?

Plagiarism can be roughly understood as "the act of presenting the words, ideas, or images of another as your own; it denies authors or creators of content they credit they are due" (American Psychological Association, 2022a).

Plagiarism, however, is not the same as plagiarism. There are different types of plagiarism, with varying extents. First of all, a distinction is made between the adoption of text passages, the adoption of other people's ideas and the adoption of own ideas that have already been published (Roig, 2015, p. 3ff). When talking about the **adoption of text passages**, a distinction is made between **full and partial plagiarism**.

Full plagiarism

In the case of **full plagiarism**, the work is either mostly or completely taken over from a single literature source "without acknowledging the original authors using a quotation marks (Anney & Mosha, 2015, p. 205). This takes place, for example, in the form of an exchange of the cover page or only by reformatting the plagiarized work.

Furthermore, it is also called full plagiarism if a foreign-language work is translated into the own language. In all these cases, we are talking about theft of intellectual property (Sousa-Silva, 2014, p. 70).

Another form of full plagiarism is paying a ghostwriter to write the entire work (Martin, 2016, p. 919).

Partial plagiarism

In contrast to this is so-called partial plagiarism, in which the entire work is not plagiarised from one source but is instead taken from multiple different sources and incorporated into different passages of the text. In these cases, the text has merely been extensively paraphrased (International Journal of Education, Business and Economics Research, 2022).

Idea plagiarism

Plagiarism that is not due to a word-for-word adoption of a text passage, but to an adoption of foreign ideas and arguments, is called idea plagiarism. In this case, the ideas or arguments are reproduced in the author's own words, but falsely presented as his own (American Psychological Association, 2021).

Self-plagiarism

In writing a paper, it is of course allowed to use own thoughts, arguments or even ideas more than once. However, these must also be cited as references in the remaining work. If in this case the first publication is not listed as a reference, this falls under self-plagiarism. Although this is not the same as stealing someone else's ideas, the reader is still entitled to the actuality of the idea and knowledge about the respective background (American Psychological Association, 2022a). However, the submission of a paper that has already been written in another course is not allowed. Using the same paper in multiple courses violates the academic integrity policy. Students who wish to include work from previous courses in their final thesis, should first discuss this idea with their supervisor (American Psychological Association, 2022a).

2. WHAT DOES TURNITIN DO?

- The IU uses the **plagiarism software** Turnitin. The written assignments are to be turned in here, in order to check them or rather inspect them for plagiarism.

- Turnitin gives an indication of which parts of the text have been used word-for-word. The **decision** whether an assignment is actually considered plagiarism is always **at the discretion of the respective examiner**.

- Furthermore, it is mandatory that a signed anti-plagiarism pledge is provided by the student in electronic form. Exceptions are final theses. Every bachelor's or master's thesis must contain a **signed anti-plagiarism pledge**. In this Statement, the student ensures that he has completed their assignment **independently**.

3. CONSEQUENCES OF PLAGIARISM

If an assignment is handed in in which plagiarism has been proven, the student involved has attempted to cheat. In this case, the **assessment** is marked as "**insufficient**“, and the module or part of the module is revoked. In addition, no credit points will be awarded.

4. CHECKLIST: HOW CAN I AVOID PLAGIARIZING?

- Both **time and performance pressure** are often causes for plagiarism (Malik, Mahroof & Ashraf, 2021, p. 2). Therefore, it is sensible, that you create a schedule before you begin writing your assignment, in order to best avoid feeling overly constrained by time.

- It is certainly permitted to use unfamiliar ideas in your assignment. However, these need to be properly identified. Therefore, it is important that any ideas, thoughts or arguments are always referenced with sources (American Psychological Association, 2021).

- It is always good to **structure newly acquired knowledge**. This means that when researching and creating a possible collection of thoughts, you must make sure that you always note down the source immediately so that you can avoid searching for your sources later (Meurer & Schluchter, 2017, p. 20). A reference management software can help you to maintain an overview of your sources.

- The **reference list** and the **source citation** are part of the writing phase just as much as the text itself. Always quote as soon as you start writing and update your reference list after each writing process. A reference list is not sufficient as the only source reference. "In general, each work cited in the text must appear in the reference list, and each work in the reference list must be cited in the text" (American Psychological Association, 2022b).

- If you want to use **verbatim quotations** in your work, you must also mark them accordingly. If you write the author's words verbatim, you must put them in quotation marks and include the source location in your notes (American Psychological Association, 2021).

- In the case of non-verbatim quotations, in other words quotations with the same meaning, you have to reproduce the content in your own words. They **must also** be cited appropriately in the body text (ibid). If you are not sure, quote in case of doubt.

- **Before handing in** your work, **check** whether your reference list and the references in the body text are complete and that you have also cited thoughts, ideas or arguments appropriately.

We wish you all the best as you begin writing your written assignment!

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